- This book maintains the complete record of all animals, plants, other species but it has no information about the microbes.



World Wildlife Day is observed on March 3rd every year.

22.5.3 Red Data Book of India

India, a mega-diverse country with only 2.4% of the world's land area, accounts for 7-8% of all recorded species, including over 45,000 species of plants and 91,000 species of animals. The country's diverse physical features and climatic conditions have resulted in a variety of ecosystems such as forests, wetlands, grasslands, deserts, coastal and marine ecosystems which harbour and sustain high biodiversity and contribute to human well being. Four out of 34 globally identified biodiversity hotspots, the Himalayas, the Western Ghats, the North-East, and the Nicobar Islands, can be found in India.

India became a state member of IUCN in 1969, through the Ministry of environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC). The IUCN India country office was established in 2007 in New Delhi. Red Data Book of India contains the conservation status of animals and plants which are found in the Indian subcontinent. Surveys conducted by the Zoological Survey of India and the Botanical Survey of India under the guidance of the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change provide the data for this book.

22.6 Conservation

According to WWF (World Wildlife Fund) there has been 60% decrease in the size of population of animals, birds, fish, reptiles and amphibians over the past 40 years. In order to leave something for the future generation, we need to conserve it now. Conservation is the protection, preservation, management of wildlife and natural resource such as forest and water. Conservation of biodiversity helps us to protect, maintain and recover endangered animals and plant species. Conservation is of two types. They are:

- In-situ conservation (within habitat)
- Ex-situ conservation (outside the habitat)

22.6.1 In-situ conservation

It is nothing but conservation of living resources within the natural ecosystem in which they occur. This is achieved by protection of natural habitat and maintenance of endangered species in certain protected areas such as national parks, wildlife or bird sanctuaries and biosphere reserves. In India, there are about 73 national parks, 416 sanctuaries and 12 biosphere reserves.

a. National Parks

National park is an area which is strictly reserved for the betterment of the wildlife. Here, activities like forestry, grazing or cultivation are not permitted. Even private ownership rights are not allowed in these areas. The national parks cover an area of 100 – 500 square kilometers. In these parks a single plant or animal species are preserved.

Table 22.4 National Parks in India

Name	State	Established year
Jim Corbett National Park	Uttarakhand	1936
Dudhwa National Park	Uttar Pradesh	1977
Gir National Park	Gujarat	1975
Kanha National Park	Madhyapradesh	1955
Sundarbans National Park	West Bengal	1984



Figure 22.9 Tiger in Corbett National Park

8th_Science_Unit-22_EM.indd 269 23/02/2024 12:46:48